



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Renting an Apartment & Housing

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 09

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to describe a home, ask questions before renting, discuss rent and utilities, report maintenance problems, and arrange a visit or repair.

Build your housing vocabulary first, then practise questions with “Is there...?”, “Are there...?”, and “Does it include...?”. Finish with a realistic apartment viewing and maintenance role-play.

Communication goal

Before agreeing to rent a place, ask concrete questions about cost, what is included, rules, condition, and location. Clear questions now prevent expensive surprises later.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: learn the key language, practise the structure, and then use it in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful chunks

02

BUILD

Grammar + model dialogue

03

SPEAK

Writing + role-play

Warm-up

1. Do you prefer a house or an apartment? Why?
2. What are the three most important things in a home for you?
3. Which bills are usually separate from rent where you live?
4. What apartment problem would be most annoying to you?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English using short sentences. Do not worry about mistakes yet. The goal is to activate the topic before studying the new language.



VOCABULARY 01

Essential vocabulary

Study the meaning and then read each example aloud. Try to connect each word to a real situation from your own life.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
rent	aluguel	The rent is due on the first day of the month.
landlord	proprietário / locador	I contacted the landlord about the leak.
tenant	inquilino	The tenant signed the lease.
lease	contrato de aluguel	The lease is for twelve months.
deposit	caução / depósito	The security deposit is one month of rent.
utilities	contas de água, energia etc.	Utilities are not included.
furnished	mobiliado	The apartment is fully furnished.
unfurnished	sem mobília	The unit is rented unfurnished.
bedroom	quarto	It has two bedrooms.
balcony	sacada / varanda	The balcony faces the park.
laundry	lavanderia	There is shared laundry downstairs.
appliance	eletrodoméstico	The kitchen appliances are new.
heating	aquecimento	Is heating included in the rent?
air conditioning	ar-condicionado	The apartment has air conditioning.
neighborhood	bairro	The neighborhood is quiet and safe.
maintenance	manutenção	Maintenance will come tomorrow morning.



VOCABULARY 02

Common housing problems and questions

These phrases help you describe the condition of a property and communicate with a landlord or building manager.

EXPRESSION	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USE
water leak	vazamento de água	There is a water leak under the sink.
clogged drain	ralo / pia entupida	The kitchen drain is clogged.
power outlet	tomada	This power outlet is not working.
broken heater	aquecedor quebrado	The heater stopped working.
no hot water	sem água quente	There has been no hot water since yesterday.
noisy neighbors	vizinhos barulhentos	The neighbors upstairs are very noisy.
included in the rent	incluído no aluguel	Is internet included in the rent?
pet-friendly	aceita animais	Is the building pet-friendly?
available from	disponível a partir de	When is the apartment available from?
move in	se mudar para dentro	I can move in next month.
move out	se mudar / sair	I need to move out by Friday.
schedule a viewing	agendar uma visita	Can we schedule a viewing for Saturday?

Study tip

Learn complete expressions, not only isolated words. In conversation, retrieving a ready-made chunk is much faster than building every sentence from zero.



USEFUL PHRASES

What to say in real situations

These phrases are designed to be spoken. Read them aloud and imagine the exact situation where you would use each one.

SITUATION	PHRASE	USE / MEANING
Before viewing	Is the apartment still available?	Confirm availability.
	Can I schedule a viewing?	Arrange a visit.
	What is the exact monthly rent?	Confirm price.
During viewing	Are utilities included in the rent?	Ask about extra costs.
	Is there parking in the building?	Ask about facilities.
	How old are the appliances?	Check condition.
Rules	Are pets allowed?	Ask about pets.
	Is there a minimum lease period?	Ask about contract length.
	When is the deposit returned?	Ask about the deposit.
Maintenance	There is a leak under the sink.	Report a problem.
	The air conditioning is not working.	Describe a fault.
	When can someone come to fix it?	Arrange repair.

Make it yours

Choose three phrases from this page and rewrite them with details from your own life. Personal examples are easier to remember and use naturally.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

There is / are + questions about features

Use “there is” for one thing and “there are” for plural things. In questions, invert the verb: “Is there...?” and “Are there...?”. Use “Does it have...?” for features of the property.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
There is	There is a balcony.	one feature
There are	There are two bathrooms.	plural features
Is there...?	Is there a washing machine?	ask about one thing
Are there...?	Are there any extra fees?	ask about plural things
Does it have...?	Does it have air conditioning?	ask about a property feature

Rental question pattern

PRICE + INCLUDED COSTS + FEATURES + RULES + CONDITION. Ask about all five before you decide.

Mini practice

Complete: _____ there a balcony?

Complete: _____ there any extra fees?

Write a question with “Does it have...?”

Describe your home using one “there is” and one “there are” sentence.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Viewing an apartment

The renter asks about price, included costs, features, and lease conditions before making a decision.

AGENT Hi, welcome. This is the apartment you asked about.

RENTER Thanks. It looks nice. What is the monthly rent?

AGENT It is \$1,200 per month, plus electricity.

RENTER So water and internet are included?

AGENT Water is included, but internet is separate.

RENTER Okay. Is there a washing machine in the unit?

AGENT No, but there is a shared laundry room on the first floor.

RENTER Does the apartment have air conditioning?

AGENT Yes, there is one unit in the living room and one in the bedroom.

RENTER Great. Are pets allowed?

AGENT Small pets are allowed with an additional deposit.

RENTER And what is the minimum lease period?

AGENT Twelve months. If you are interested, you can apply online today.

Do not focus only on rent

The real monthly cost can include utilities, internet, parking, building fees, and insurance. Ask what is included.

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build useful sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson. More than one answer may be correct.

1. O apartamento ainda está disponível?
2. Qual é o valor do aluguel mensal?
3. As contas estão incluídas no aluguel?
4. Tem máquina de lavar no apartamento?
5. O prédio aceita animais?
6. Qual é o valor da caução?
7. Quando eu posso me mudar?
8. Podemos agendar uma visita para sábado?
9. Há um vazamento embaixo da pia.
10. O ar-condicionado não está funcionando.
11. Estamos sem água quente desde ontem.
12. Quando alguém pode vir consertar isso?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write an apartment inquiry

A useful rental message is polite, specific, and short enough for the landlord or agent to answer quickly.

Task: Write 90-120 words to a landlord or real-estate agent about an apartment listing. Introduce yourself briefly, ask whether it is available, ask about rent and utilities, ask two questions about features or rules, and request a viewing.

Try to include some of these:

- I am interested in...
- Is it still available?
- Could you confirm the monthly rent?
- Are utilities included?
- Is there...?
- Does it have...?
- Are pets allowed?
- Could we schedule a viewing...?

Simple structure

INTEREST -> AVAILABILITY -> COST -> FEATURES / RULES -> VIEWING. Keep each question clear and direct.

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I ask whether the property is available?
- ☐ Did I confirm the real monthly cost?
- ☐ Did I ask at least two property questions?
- ☐ Did I clearly request a viewing?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and complete each situation before asking the AI to correct you. Try to stay in English even when you need time to think.

Role-play 1 · Apartment viewing

The AI is the agent. Ask about rent, deposit, utilities, furniture, laundry, parking, pets, lease length, and neighborhood.

Role-play 2 · Compare two apartments

The AI gives you two options. Compare price, location, included utilities, size, and rules, then explain which one you prefer and why.

Role-play 3 · Maintenance request

You already live there. Report a water leak and a broken air conditioner, explain when the problems started, and arrange a repair time.

Questions to practise

- Is it still available?
- How much is the rent?
- What is included in the rent?
- Is there parking?
- Does it have air conditioning?
- Are pets allowed?
- How much is the deposit?
- When can I move in?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. The goal is to see what you can produce from memory, not only what you recognize on the page.

1. Translate: aluguel = _____
2. Translate: inquilino = _____
3. Translate: contrato de aluguel = _____
4. Complete: _____ there a balcony?
5. Complete: _____ there any parking spaces?
6. Write a question with “Does it have...?”
7. Translate: “As contas estão incluídas no aluguel?”
8. Translate: “O prédio aceita animais?”
9. Ask how much the deposit is.
10. Ask when you can move in.
11. Report a leak under the sink.
12. Report that the heater is not working.
13. Ask when someone can repair it.
14. Ask to schedule a viewing.
15. Name three costs you should confirm before renting.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The versions below are natural examples using the language taught in this lesson.

Grammar mini practice

- Is
- Are
- Example: Does it have a balcony?
- Example: There is a balcony. There are two bedrooms.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. Is the apartment still available?
2. What is the monthly rent?
3. Are utilities included in the rent?
4. Is there a washing machine in the apartment?
5. Is the building pet-friendly? / Are pets allowed?
6. How much is the deposit?
7. When can I move in?
8. Can we schedule a viewing for Saturday?
9. There is a leak under the sink.
10. The air conditioning is not working.
11. We have had no hot water since yesterday.
12. When can someone come to fix it?

Review strategy

Mark the sentences that felt slow or uncertain. Say those sentences aloud three times, then create one new example with the same structure.

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real objective is to understand the topic and communicate without stopping every time you need a new sentence.

1. rent
2. tenant
3. lease
4. Is
5. Are
6. Answers vary.
7. Are utilities included in the rent?
8. Are pets allowed?
9. How much is the deposit?
10. When can I move in?
- 11-14. Use the maintenance and viewing phrases.
15. Example: rent, utilities, parking / building fees.

READY FOR CONVERSATION?

If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.

- ✓ Describe a home and its features.
- ✓ Ask the key questions before renting.
- ✓ Understand rent, deposit, utilities, and lease vocabulary.
- ✓ Report a maintenance problem and arrange a repair.

Next lesson suggestion: Banking, Payments & Personal Finance